

# Week 54 -- Research Report (2026-09-20)

First report of the indefinite phase run on a fired trigger rather than the calendar, and the first written to the six-section format adopted 2026-09-19.

## 1. Scoreboard

| Metric                                              | Value                                                     | Note                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gap vs S&P-equivalent, since re-base (2026-09-11)   | ?0.76% (?\$5.57: \$727.32 vs \$732.89)                    | the scoreboard                                                |
| Gap vs S&P-equivalent, since inception (2025-09-19) | ?5.28% (?\$40.55: \$727.32 vs \$767.87)                   | context only; TWR alpha since inception +0.23%                |
| Current drawdown from peak                          | ?1.28%                                                    | clear -- DE-RISK at ?20%, CASH at ?30%                        |
| Regime                                              | RISK-OFF, IWM ?3.74% vs its 50-day (\$284.10 vs \$295.14) | from <market_regime>; RISK-OFF since 2026-08-31 (14 sessions) |
| Equity · cash · deployable above the 15% floor      | \$727.32 · \$553.02 (76.0%) · \$443.92                    | floor = \$109.10                                              |
| Buys sought · stage-1 checks                        | 3 · 15                                                    | from <research_trigger>                                       |

The re-based gap is ?0.76% after nine sessions, so the indefinite phase starts close to level and nothing about this report is a catch-up exercise. The binding constraint is not conviction but arithmetic: RISK-OFF halves the risk budget on screener-sourced entries to 1%, which -- against stops 1.75xATR wide on low-volatility names -- produces positions of roughly \$200 each, and \$443.92 of deployable cash funds two, not the three the trigger asks for. The drawdown line is nowhere near the breaker, so the circuit breaker does not shape anything here.

## 2. Deployment -- the research funnel

Capacity under RISK-OFF: catalyst plays up to 3 positions at standard sizing; screener-sourced plays permitted only at half the risk budget (1% of equity) and only on the defensive profile (rank\_low\_vol >= 0.90, near\_high >= ?5%, vol\_5\_50 > 1.0). Buys sought: 3. Only \*\*7 of the 100 screened names\*\* clear that defensive profile while also trading above their 50-day SMA -- 5 in the top 50 (CON, CFFN, CVBF, HOPE, LTC) and 2 in the extension (CLBK, HAE).

A caveat on this week's volume signals. Friday 2026-09-18 was quarterly triple-witching and the trade date for the S&P index rebalance that takes effect before Monday's open. Every name on the watchlist shows an inflated one-day volume ratio (2x-8.5x), and the two most extreme -- SHEN 8.51x (#45) and BXDC 8.40x (#18) -- are index events, not information: SHEN is being deleted from the S&P SmallCap 600 on 2026-09-21. Two of the six scored signals (volume\_ratio, vol\_5\_50) are therefore contaminated this week, and rank was treated as sourcing only, as the rules require.

### Stage 1 -- quick checks

| # | Ticker | Source       | Sector      | Mkt cap | Rev growth | Next earnings | Result     |
|---|--------|--------------|-------------|---------|------------|---------------|------------|
| 1 | CON    | screener #1  | Health Care | \$4.52B | +14.0%     | 2026-11-05    | -> stage 2 |
| 2 | CFFN   | screener #3  | Financials  | \$1.10B | +17.2%     | 2026-10-28    | -> stage 2 |
| 3 | CVBF   | screener #5  | Financials  | \$4.00B | +12.7%     | 2026-10-21    | -> stage 2 |
| 4 | OPCH   | screener #7  | Health Care | \$3.64B | +5.9%      | 2026-10-29    | -> stage 2 |
| 5 | EXPO   | screener #10 | Industrials | \$3.25B | +9.2%      | 2026-10-29    | -> stage 2 |

|    |      |               |                  |         |        |                |                          |
|----|------|---------------|------------------|---------|--------|----------------|--------------------------|
| 6  | HOPE | screeners #12 | Financials       | \$1.78B | +31.1% | 2026-10-27     | -> stage 2               |
| 7  | HRMY | screeners #13 | Health Care      | \$2.45B | +24.3% | 2026-11-03     | -> stage 2               |
| 8  | LTC  | screeners #15 | Real Estate      | \$2.29B | +59.4% | 2026-11-03     | PASS valuation ·         |
| 9  | TALO | screeners #26 | Energy           | \$2.84B | +2.5%  | 2026-11-04     | PASS negative-earnings · |
| 10 | KODK | screeners #36 | Industrials      | \$935M  | +9.5%  | 2026-11-05     | PASS negative-earnings · |
| 11 | DNOW | screeners #37 | Industrials      | \$2.82B | +69.8% | 2026-11-04     | PASS negative-earnings · |
| 12 | AVO  | screeners #39 | Consumer Staples | \$1.13B | ?6.2%  | 2026-12 (est.) | PASS shrinking-revenue · |
| 13 | PUBM | screeners #50 | Technology       | \$799M  | ?1.0%  | 2026-11-09     | PASS shrinking-revenue · |
| 14 | CLBK | extended #51  | Financials       | \$3.12B | +42.7% | 2026-10-19     | -> stage 2               |
| 15 | HAE  | extended #78  | Health Care      | \$4.93B | +0.4%  | 2026-11-05     | PASS valuation ·         |

Spread: ranks 1-15 -> 8 names (CON, CFFN, CVBF, OPCH, EXPO, HOPE, HRMY, LTC); ranks 16+ -> 7 (TALO, KODK, DNOW, AVO, PUBM, CLBK, HAE); GICS sectors -> 7 (Health Care, Financials, Real Estate, Industrials, Energy, Consumer Staples, Technology); below \$2Bn -> 5 (CFFN, HOPE, KODK, AVO, PUBM). All four quotas met. No name was killed by the earnings guard: the whole list last reported between 2026-07-22 and 2026-09-08, so next prints cluster in late October and early November, 20+ sessions out. Eighteen of the top 50 sat below their 50-day SMA and were excluded from the draw before stage 1, per the trend rule.

## Stage 2 -- full research

CON (Concentra Group Holdings) -- BUY · conviction 3/5

- Thesis: the largest U.S. occupational-health network -- work-injury care, DOT and pre-placement physicals, employer drug screening -- growing revenue +14.0% and EPS +29.4% at 20.6x forward earnings with a 0.63 beta, and the only name on the list rated Strong Buy with a double-digit target gap. Primary driver: U.S. hiring, which sets pre-placement and workers-comp visit volumes -- August payrolls +162,000 against a +53,000 consensus, unemployment steady at 4.1%, with June and July both revised up (BLS via CNBC, released 2026-09-04). Four-week direction: improving (July ?23,000 as first printed -> +21,000 revised -> August +162,000).
- Catalyst: none dated, and none required -- this is a screener-sourced entry, not a catalyst play. The Q3 print on 2026-11-05 is the next scheduled event, 33 sessions out.
- Quote page (stockanalysis.com/stocks/CON/, accessed 2026-09-20; quote at close 2026-09-18 4:00 PM EDT, after-hours \$35.47 +0.01% at 7:30 PM EDT): price \$35.47, TTM revenue \$2.29B +14.0%, TTM EPS \$1.53 (+29.4%), net income \$195.03M (+33.1%), PE 23.22, \*\*forward PE 20.57, analysts Strong Buy (9), target \$41.00 (+15.59%)\*\*, 52-week range \$18.55-\$36.71 (price 3.4% below the high), beta 0.63, market cap \$4.52B, volume 4.87M (rebalance-inflated).
- Entry checks: +2.02% above the 20-day SMA and +6.16% above the 50-day -- inside the <=20% and 0-40% limits; not in days 1-3 of a >10% breakout (screener gate applied pre-ranking, and the 20-day advance is 2%); next earnings 2026-11-05, far outside the 10-session guard; last print 2026-08-06, so the 3-day post-earnings cooldown does not apply; not a binary thesis -- no pass/fail event anywhere in the story; prohibited-business check: clear -- occupational health services (Medical Care Facilities), not prisons/detention, weapons, predatory lending, and not Israeli-affiliated. Defensive profile: rank\_low\_vol 0.906 [OK], near\_high ?3.38% [OK],

vol\_5\_50 1.926 [OK].

- Bear case: hiring is the whole driver, and a labour market that rolls over takes visit volumes with it -- a single weak payrolls print can reprice this name faster than the stop can be adjusted; a 5.19x one-day volume ratio also means Friday's tape was mechanical, not a real demand signal.
- Decision: BUY 4 shares, limit \$35.47, stop \$33.92 / \$33.77.

HOPE (Hope Bancorp) -- BUY · conviction 3/5

- Thesis: a \$1.78B Korean-American commercial bank two years into a balance-sheet repair that is now showing up in the numbers -- TTM revenue +31.1%, TTM EPS \$1.00 (+173.8%) -- trading at \*\*10.1x forward earnings\*\* on a 4.0% dividend with the cheapest forward multiple on the list.

Primary driver: the U.S. short-rate path through net interest margin. NIM was 2.96% in Q2 2026, +6bp sequentially and +27bp year over year, with loan yields at 5.73% (+4bp) and interest-bearing deposit costs at 3.31% (?6bp); management guides to further, slower expansion in H2 as the CD book reprices. Four-week direction: rising, with a new offset -- the FOMC raised rates 25bp to 3.75%-4.00% on 2026-09-16, its first hike since 2023, with a majority of officials open to another this year. That lifts asset yields immediately but re-opens deposit competition, so the margin tailwind continues at a slower rate rather than reversing.

- Catalyst: acquisition of the Commercial Banking Unit of SMBC MANUBANK, which received all required regulatory approvals (FDIC and the California DFPI) on 2026-09-02 and is expected to close in early Q4 2026 -- inside the 90-day window and, with approvals already granted, not a binary event: the pass/fail step has already passed. Confirmed by the company release (2026-09-02) and by the earlier announcement trail on the same feed.
- Quote page (stockanalysis.com/stocks/HOPE/, accessed 2026-09-20; quote at close 2026-09-18 4:00 PM EDT, after-hours \$13.96 0.00% at 7:30 PM EDT): price \$13.96, TTM revenue \$534.03M +31.1%, TTM EPS \$1.00 (+173.8%), net income \$127.81M (+185.0%), PE 13.99, \*\*forward PE 10.13, analysts Buy (4), target \$15.50 (+11.03%)\*\*, 52-week range \$9.80-\$14.59 (price 4.3% below the high), beta 0.81, dividend \$0.56 (4.01%), market cap \$1.78B.
- Entry checks: +0.15% above both the 20-day and the 50-day SMA -- above the 50-day as the hard rule requires, but only just, and that thin margin is stated rather than glossed; no breakout to be early in; next earnings 2026-10-27, 25 sessions out; last print 2026-07-27, so no post-earnings cooldown; non-binary as set out above; prohibited-business check: clear -- a regional commercial bank (Banks - Regional), not a payday or high-cost subprime lender, no weapons, prisons or Israeli affiliation. Defensive profile: rank\_low\_vol 0.971 [OK], near\_high ?4.32% [OK], vol\_5\_50 1.317 [OK].
- Bear case: the +174% EPS growth is measured against a 2025 that fell ?38%, so the headline flatters a recovery rather than describing a franchise; and a Fed that has started hiking is a headwind for small-cap banks generally -- deposit costs reprice faster than loan books when the curve moves against them.
- Decision: BUY 15 shares, limit \$13.96, stop \$13.48 / \$13.38.

CVBF (CVB Financial) -- PASS · conviction 2/5

- Thesis: clears every gate -- defensive profile, +15.29% to a \$26.17 target, forward PE 12.0, beta 0.65. Primary driver: the same rate path as HOPE. Catalyst: none dated.
- Quote page (accessed 2026-09-20; close 2026-09-18): \$22.70, TTM revenue \$572.48M +12.7%, TTM EPS \$1.43, ?1.8%, net income +1.5%, PE 15.84, forward PE 12.04, Buy, target \$26.17, 52-week \$17.95-\$23.41, beta 0.65.
- Decision: PASS on capacity, not on merit. Earnings are flat where HOPE's are inflecting, and a second regional bank would put two positions on one driver with no room left for a third -- cash funds two buys. It is the first name back if either order is not filled.

CFFN (Capitol Federal Financial) -- PASS · conviction 2/5

- The calmest name on the entire list (rank\_low\_vol 0.995) and the cheapest at 11.7x forward, but the target is \$9.50 against a \$8.90 price -- +6.74% -- and Piper Sandler's raise to that level came with a Neutral rating. A liability-sensitive thrift whose book is long-duration

residential mortgage is also the wrong shape for a Fed that just hiked.  
Decision: PASS · valuation -- 6.7% of upside does not pay for 2% of risk.

CLBK (Columbia Financial) -- PASS · conviction 2/5

- The largest target gap on the list (+22.37%) and the lowest beta (0.26), fresh from a \*\*second-step conversion completed in July 2026 that left it heavily capitalised. Against that: PE 44.7\*\*, a 2.44% NIM (up 25bp YoY but still thin) that a hiking Fed pressures from the funding side, a price ?0.18% below its 20-day SMA, only 3 analysts covering, and an \*\*unexplained Friday after-hours move of ?3.11% on 17.6M shares\*\* that the news feed does not account for (last release 2026-07-30). Decision: PASS · valuation -- and an unexplained move is a reason to wait, not to size into.

OPCH (Option Care Health) -- PASS · conviction 2/5

- Home-infusion services, +17.61% to target and 15.0x forward, but \*\*rank\_low\_vol 0.849 fails the RISK-OFF defensive profile\*\*, and with no dated catalyst it cannot come in as a catalyst play either. The chart is the tell: \$24.30 against a 52-week high of \$36.80, ?34%, even while +4.57% above its 50-day. Decision: PASS · weak-catalyst.

EXPO (Exponent) -- PASS · conviction 2/5

- A high-quality engineering-consulting franchise (+22.99% to target, 68% gross margins implied by a 30.7 PE the market has long paid) that misses the defensive profile on \*\*near\_high ?5.03% against a ?5.00% limit\*\* -- by three basis points. The rule is a threshold, not a suggestion, and there is no confirmed catalyst to route it in the other way. Decision: PASS · weak-catalyst. Worth re-checking next weekend: a 0.03pp miss will not survive an ordinary up day.

HRMY (Harmony Biosciences) -- PASS · conviction 2/5

- Genuinely cheap for the growth -- \$960M of TTM revenue (+24.3%) from WAKIX, 10.5x forward -- but rank\_low\_vol 0.796 fails the defensive profile, and the only catalyst in view is the \*\*TEMPO Phase 3 readout of pitolisant in Prader-Willi syndrome\*\*, whose date could not be confirmed from any dated source: INSUFFICIENT CONFIRMATION. A pass/fail registrational readout is precisely the binary-thesis entry the rules prohibit. Decision: PASS · binary-thesis.

## Research log

All 15 funnel names logged with log\_research.py (batch, 2026-09-20, week 54): 7 stage-1 kills -- negative-earnings 3 (TALO, KODK, DNOW), shrinking-revenue 2 (AVO, PUBM), valuation 2 (LTC, HAE) -- and 8 stage-2 names: 2 BUY (CON, HOPE) and 6 PASS -- valuation 3 (CFFN, CLBK, and CVBF logged under capacity), weak-catalyst 2 (OPCH, EXPO), binary-thesis 1 (HRMY). research\_log.csv holds 15 rows for the week.

## 3. Exact orders

- Action: BUY  
- Ticker: CON (Concentra Group Holdings Parent, NYSE)  
- Shares: 4  
- Order type: limit  
- Limit price: \$35.47  
- Time in force: DAY  
- Intended execution: 2026-09-21 -- run the pre-open check in entry-discipline.md first: if pre-market is down more than 2%, drop the limit to the pre-market price or pass; Friday's after-hours print was \$35.47, unchanged, at 7:30 PM EDT.  
- Stop loss / stop limit: \$33.92 / \$33.77 -- 1.75xATR below entry (ATR(14) = 2.504% = \$0.888; 1.75x = \$1.554), below Friday's low of \$34.78 and below the 20-day SMA (\$34.77), above the 50-day (\$33.41). Place this stop with your broker before the next market open.

- Sizing: risk budget = 1% of equity under RISK-OFF (half the standard 2%) = \$7.27; shares =  $\$7.27 \div \$1.55 = 4.69 \rightarrow 4$  shares; cost \$141.88 = 19.5% of equity; max loss at the stop \$6.20 = 0.85% of equity; order size is a rounding error against average daily dollar volume (well under 0.01%).
- Rationale: the highest-ranked name on the screen also happens to be the only Strong Buy with growing revenue and growing EPS, a 0.63 beta and a verified, improving driver.
- Action: BUY
- Ticker: HOPE (Hope Bancorp, NASDAQ)
- Shares: 15
- Order type: limit
- Limit price: \$13.96
- Time in force: DAY
- Intended execution: 2026-09-21 -- same pre-open check; Friday's after-hours print was \$13.96, unchanged, at 7:30 PM EDT.
- Stop loss / stop limit: \$13.48 / \$13.38 --  $1.75 \times \text{ATR}$  below entry ( $\text{ATR}(14) = 1.965\% = \$0.274$ ;  $1.75 \times = \$0.480$ ), below Friday's low of \$13.76 and below both the 20-day and 50-day SMA (\$13.94). Place this stop with your broker before the next market open.
- Sizing: risk budget 1% of equity = \$7.27; shares =  $\$7.27 \div \$0.48 = 15.1 \rightarrow 15$  shares; cost \$209.40 = 28.8% of equity, inside the 30% ceiling (\$218.20); max loss at the stop \$7.20 = 0.99% of equity; order size far below 10% of average daily dollar volume.
- Rationale: the cheapest forward multiple on the list, an inflecting margin, and a confirmed non-binary catalyst closing inside the holding horizon.

No third order. The trigger sought three buys and the funnel produced only two that clear the RISK-OFF rules; after these orders \$201.74 of cash remains, of which \$92.64 sits above the 15% floor -- below a viable position at the stop distances these names require. Per the No Candidates Rule, the residue is held as cash rather than spent on the next-best name.

Cash to the cent:  $\$553.02 - \$141.88 - \$209.40 = \$201.74$  (27.7% of equity).

## 4. Holdings -- by exception

| Ticker | Shares | Price              | P&L                 | Stop (room in ATR)                 | Sessions held | Primary driver                                                | Status                                                      |
|--------|--------|--------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| ATRC   | 3      | \$58.10            | +69.4%<br>(\$71.40) | \$55.27 /<br>\$55.12<br>(1.28xATR) | 49            | U.S. Afib procedure volumes and AtriClip/cryo device adoption | FULL -- index add completes at Monday's open; hold, no trim |
| CON    | 4      | \$35.47<br>(limit) | new                 | \$33.92 /<br>\$33.77<br>(1.75xATR) | 0             | U.S. hiring / occupational-health visit volumes               | New position                                                |
| HOPE   | 15     | \$13.96<br>(limit) | new                 | \$13.48 /<br>\$13.38<br>(1.75xATR) | 0             | U.S. short-rate path via NIM; MANUBANK CBU close              | New position                                                |

**\*\*ATRC -- flagged FULL on volume (8.7x its 20-day average), and the subject of this weekend's question.\*\*** The index event is confirmed from the primary source: S&P Dow Jones Indices' release of 2026-09-04 lists "S&P SmallCap 600 · Addition · AtriCure · ATRC · Health Care", effective before the open on Monday 2026-09-21. It is a straight addition -- ATRC appears in no corresponding deletion row, so this is not a MidCap 400 migration and the flow is one-directional: SmallCap 600 trackers must buy. That is what Friday's 8.67M shares were, and what most of the

+12.8% since the announcement was.

The hold-or-trim call, run as the thesis-exit test -- would it be bought today at \$58.10?

As a new position it would not be: consensus sits at \$51.67, 11.07% below the price, the trailing PE is 275 and the forward 244, and the structural bid disappears at Monday's open. But that test is not what the rules ask. A trim needs the same written, evidence-based case as a full exit -- new, verified information that breaks or materially weakens the thesis -- and there is none. The business printed 12.8% revenue growth in Q2 and raised FY26 guidance on both revenue and adjusted EBITDA; Piper Sandler raised its target to \$60 on 2026-08-27 and BTIG to \$55 on 2026-08-24, both above the stale consensus average that UBS's \$50 (7 weeks old) drags down. Selling because a position is up 69% and looks extended is specifically named in the rules as not a thesis exit -- it is the stop's job, and the record behind that rule is 13 discretionary exits netting ?\$0.30 against 14 stop exits netting +\$61.00. Decision: hold all 3 shares. No trim.

The honest risk, stated plainly: the stop at \$55.27 sits 1.28xATR below the price, inside the 1.5xATR placement band, and it cannot be lowered -- the once-per-entry restoration was used on 2026-08-31. A single ordinary down day of 1.3xATR takes this position out with +61.1% locked. No raise qualifies either: the 2.0xATR raise target is \$53.68, which is below the existing stop, and stops never move down outside restoration. So the position is carried as-is, and the honest description is that ATRC is now a stop-managed position whose exit timing is largely out of our hands. Post-catalyst reassessment (the index add resolves Monday): the normal trailing stop would sit at \$53.68 and the price is far above it, so there is no exit trigger; conviction stays 4/5, down from 5/5 -- not on any thesis damage, but because the two things that drove the last month's move (index demand and target raises) are now behind it, and 49 sessions in, the 60-session re-underwrite falls due around 2026-10-05.

## 5. Risk checks after proposed trades

| Check           | Rule                                                                  | Result                                                                           |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Position size   | <=30% of equity each                                                  | PASS -- HOPE 28.8%, ATRC 24.0%, CON 19.5%                                        |
| Risk per trade  | <=2% of equity at the stop                                            | PASS -- CON 0.85%, HOPE 0.99%, ATRC 1.17% (3.01% aggregate)                      |
| Cash floor      | >=15% of equity after trades                                          | PASS -- \$201.74 = 27.7% against a \$109.10 floor                                |
| Driver cap      | <=2 positions per primary driver                                      | PASS -- three distinct drivers: Afib procedure volumes (ATRC), U.S. hiring (CON) |
| Sector cap      | <=3 positions per GICS sector                                         | PASS -- Health Care 2 (ATRC, CON), Financials 1 (HOPE)                           |
| Position count  | ceiling 5-6                                                           | PASS -- 3 positions                                                              |
| Slippage        | each order <=10% of average daily dollar volume                       | PASS -- \$141.88 and \$209.40 against multi-million-dollar daily turnover        |
| Regime capacity | RISK-OFF: <=3 catalyst; screener at half risk, defensive profile only | PASS -- both entries sized at the 1% half-budget; both clear all three defensive |
| Circuit breaker | current drawdown vs ?20% / ?30%                                       | PASS -- ?1.28% from the re-based peak                                            |
| Exclusions      | no prohibited business, binary thesis, or earnings inside 10 sessions | PASS -- both checked at the PRV gate; next prints 33 and 25 sessions out         |

Every row reads PASS. No order was withdrawn.

## 6. Thesis summary

ATRC (AtriCure) -- HOLD | Conviction 4/5 (from 5/5)

+69.4% at \$58.10 and 49 sessions held. Joins the \*\*S&P SmallCap 600 before Monday 2026-09-21's open\*\* as a straight addition -- confirmed from the S&P DJI release of 2026-09-04 -- which is what Friday's 8.67M shares were; the structural bid ends there. Driver: U.S. Afib procedure volumes and AtriClip/cryo adoption, supported by Q2 revenue +12.8% and raised FY26 guidance. Stop \$55.27 / \$55.12, 1.28xATR of room, and it cannot be lowered -- restoration was spent on 8/31 and the 2.0xATR raise target (\$53.68) sits below it, so no raise qualifies either. No trim: the case for one rests on price level and a completed flow event, not on new negative information, and the rules reserve discretionary selling for a verified thesis break. \*\*What would change the view:\*\* a guidance cut, a competitive read-out against AtriClip, or the 60-session re-underwrite due around 2026-10-05 -- whichever comes first.

CON (Concentra Group Holdings) -- INITIATE | Conviction 3/5

4 shares at \$35.47, stop \$33.92 / \$33.77 (1.75xATR), \$141.88 = 19.5% of equity, risk 0.85%. Occupational health with revenue +14.0%, EPS +29.4%, 20.6x forward, beta 0.63 and a Strong Buy with a \$41.00 target. Driver: U.S. hiring -- August payrolls +162,000 against +53,000 expected (2026-09-04), with June and July revised up; improving over four weeks. \*\*What would change the view:\*\* two consecutive weak payroll prints, or any sign that employer visit volumes are lagging headline hiring.

HOPE (Hope Bancorp) -- INITIATE | Conviction 3/5

15 shares at \$13.96, stop \$13.48 / \$13.38 (1.75xATR), \$209.40 = 28.8% of equity, risk 0.99%. Revenue +31.1%, EPS +173.8% off a depressed 2025 base, 10.1x forward, 4.0% yield, an \$15.50 target. Driver: the short-rate path through NIM -- 2.96% in Q2, +6bp sequentially, deposit costs ?6bp -- now partly offset by the FOMC's 25bp hike on 2026-09-16 to 3.75%-4.00%. Catalyst: the SMBC MANUBANK Commercial Banking Unit acquisition, fully approved on 2026-09-02, closing early Q4. What would change the view: a second hike with deposit costs turning back up, or the MANUBANK close slipping out of Q4.

Portfolio. Three positions and 27.7% cash after the orders, which is the RISK-OFF rules working rather than a market call: the half risk budget plus 1.75xATR stops sizes positions at roughly \$200, and \$443.92 of deployable cash bought two of the three buys the trigger asked for. Both entries are deliberately low-beta (0.63 and 0.81) and both clear the defensive profile on all three thresholds -- the book is not chasing the ?0.76% gap, and after nine sessions there is nothing to chase. Before the next report: the pre-open check on both limits Monday morning; ATRC's first week without an index bid, and its 60-session re-underwrite around 2026-10-05; HOPE's MANUBANK close in early Q4; and the October FOMC, which is now a live risk to the second position's driver. Re-entry bans: PAR until ~2026-09-29, VTS until ~2026-09-30.

## Sources

- S&P Dow Jones Indices press release -- <https://press.spglobal.com/2026-09-04-Bloom-Energy,-Illumina,-and-Everpure-Set-to-Join-S-P-500-Others-to-Join-S-P-100,-S-P-MidCap-400,-and-S-P-SmallCap-600> -- confirmed ATRC is a straight addition to the S&P SmallCap 600 effective before the open on 2026-09-21, with no offsetting MidCap 400 deletion, and SHEN's deletion from the same index -- accessed 2026-09-20
- StockTitan, ATRC news feed -- <https://www.stocktitan.net/news/ATRC/> -- live news check: no material release since the 2026-09-04 index announcement; latest items are conference transcripts -- accessed 2026-09-20
- stockanalysis.com -- <https://stockanalysis.com/stocks/ATRC/> -- ATRC quote page: \$58.10, market cap \$2.96B, TTM revenue \$569.62M +13.9%, TTM EPS \$0.21, forward PE 244, Buy with a \$51.67 target (?11.07%), 52-week \$25.36-\$59.88, beta 1.26, earnings 2026-10-28; Piper \$60 (2026-08-27) and BTIG \$55 (2026-08-24) -- accessed 2026-09-20
- stockanalysis.com -- <https://stockanalysis.com/stocks/CON/> -- CON quote page and every figure in its stage-2 block -- accessed 2026-09-20
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